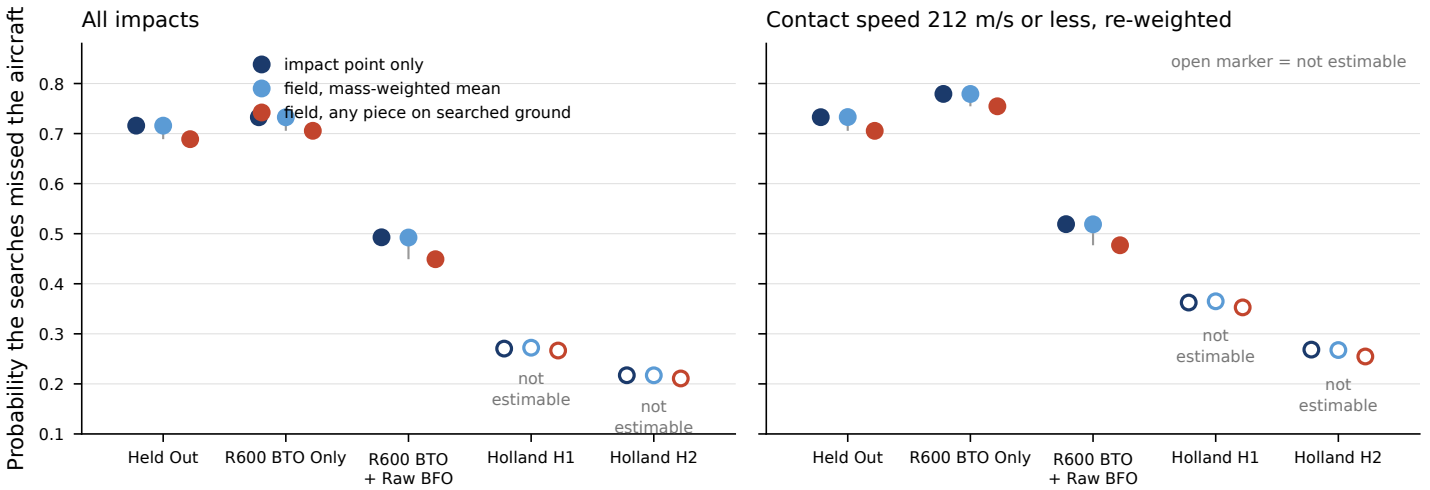
What counts as a detection moves the result more than the shape of the wreckage field



WHAT THIS SHOWS. Each dot is the probability that the seabed searches missed the aircraft, for one choice about what the sonars had to see. Dark blue: only the point where the aircraft hit the water. Light blue: the whole field of wreckage on the sea floor, with heavy pieces counting for more. Red: a find if ANY single piece lies on searched ground. The first two almost coincide, so the shape of the field hardly matters. The gap down to red is what the rule for a find is worth. Columns 4 and 5 cannot be calculated correctly from this set of flight paths yet, and are shown open. Every number is provisional.

TECHNICAL. Source: ocean settling's run C seabed wreckage samples (next-run-c-core-set and -speedcap, 11 Oct 2026 ~07:00 UTC, settling 9330d4c) on end of flight's core run C, 4 strata x 8 seeds. Constraint +unpowered, stratum weights from end of flight's family-evidence-run-c.json, 00:19 re-weighted mixture. Every 5th outcome (step 5): 8,000-40,002 outcomes and 0.35-1.9 M settled elements per column. Seabed search likelihood: ATSB Phase 2 union 120,486.5 km2 and Bluefin-21/Artemis 771.4 km2, detection probability 0.945 and 0.900 conditional on a detectable target, undetectable fraction rho = 0.05 (no published value), shared miss dependence, coverage raster 0.01 deg, bilinear. Ocean Infinity 2018 and 2025-26 layers excluded. Outcome key row x 2^20 + draw (ocean settling's declared convention). LABELS core run C NOT CONVERGED (free split-half 0.918 against floor 0.924); end of flight physics PROVISIONAL, no structural limit (G13), rapid descents above 6,500 ft/min and unloading not reachable; settling breakup table PROVISIONAL, residual roll P(left) = 0.8 PROVISIONAL; Holland H1 and H2 NOT ESTIMABLE (pooled Kish effective sample size 66 and 171; 586 and 1,116 distinct impacts behind 40,000 outcomes).